

programs as spyware removal programs, thereby fooling users into downloading more spyware.

Spyware programs are getting more malicious by the day. They could install a variety of application DLLs on your computer that allow hackers to snoop on what you're doing. These DLLs can do a variety of things to your computer—monitor your keystrokes

Some Terms Explained

Freeware

As the name suggests, freeware is software that is available for download and use free of charge. The essential difference between freeware and adware is that freeware is free software without advertising content. Freeware also does not usually come with technical support on the developer's behalf. As opposed to shareware, freeware can be used indefinitely and does not expire after a particular period of use.

Shareware

Put simply, shareware is “try before you buy” software. Shareware allows you to use the software for a trial period, after which you are asked to purchase it. The purchase may be of the entire software package, or a registration code to unlock the original shareware package for unrestricted use. The best part about shareware packages are that they allow you to evaluate them before actually buying, so you know whether the package suits your requirements or not. And as the name implies, users are encouraged to *share* the shareware package with friends.

Warez

Warez is essentially pirated stuff (games, applications, music albums, *et al*) that are available for download over the Internet. There are clear violations of copyright laws in downloading and using warez.

on or offline, access your word processor, hijack your Web browser, display advertisements, and more. And some spyware leaves your computer even more open to attack from other spyware.

Gator basically displays advertising on the computer on which it is installed. It also installs a host of other applications like GotSmiley, Dashbar, and more, which further slow down your computer.